



SOFIA UNIVERSITY "St. KLIMENT OHRIDSKI"
FACULTY of MATHEMATICS and INFORMATICS
1164 SOFIA, BULGARIA
Phone +(3592)8161500

Recommendation letter
from Associate Professor Minko Markov,
Faculty of Mathematics and Informatics, Sofia University
Department of Logic
Sofia, Bulgaria

Applicant: Kristiyan Ivanov Garchev

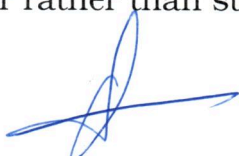
To whom it may concern:

It is a pleasure to write this letter in support of Kristiyan Garchev and his application for graduate study. I know Kristiyan through subjects closely connected with my own teaching and academic interests, including Discrete Mathematics, Algorithms, Automata Theory, and Compilers, and also through his work as a teaching assistant in discrete mathematics. Over the years I have taught many talented students, but Kristiyan is one of the few who stands out not only for his technical strength, but also for the clarity and speed of his thinking.

My first strong impression of Kristiyan came from his work in Discrete Mathematics and Algorithms. These subjects reveal very quickly whether a student can reason precisely, identify structure in a problem, and construct solutions that are both elegant and correct. Kristiyan consistently showed all of these qualities. He does not simply arrive at answers; he understands why a method works, how it relates to general principles, and where its limitations are.

This strength became even more evident in more theoretical computer science subjects such as Automata Theory and Compilers. In these areas, students must combine formal reasoning with technical discipline. Kristiyan handled this balance exceptionally well. He is comfortable with abstraction, yet he never loses sight of implementation and correctness. He can move from formal models and proofs to actual computational thinking with unusual ease, which is exactly the kind of ability that marks out a serious student.

His background in competitive programming further confirms this. Kristiyan has participated successfully in algorithmic and programming competitions and has built a profile that reflects real problem-solving power rather than superficial coding

Signed: 
Minko Markov



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fluency. Competitive programming is a harsh filter: it demands speed, precision, efficiency, and mental resilience. Kristiyan has shown repeatedly that he can solve difficult problems under pressure and implement his ideas cleanly. His programming skills are not merely practical; they are grounded in strong mathematical and algorithmic intuition.

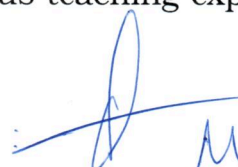
I have also had the opportunity to observe him as a teaching assistant in discrete mathematics, and this deserves emphasis. Strong students are common enough; strong students who can explain abstract material to others are much rarer. Kristiyan communicates clearly, approaches teaching seriously, and helps students grasp concepts that many initially find difficult. This reflects not only mastery of the material, but also maturity and academic responsibility.

What makes Kristiyan especially impressive is that he has not developed narrowly. Although I know him primarily through logic- and algorithm-related areas, it is clear that he has built a broader intellectual profile spanning mathematics, theoretical computer science, and modern computational methods. He has the kind of foundation that allows him to adapt well to demanding graduate work where rigor and technical fluency must go together.

His record in competitions reinforces this overall picture. Kristiyan has earned distinctions in both mathematics and programming, which is a rare combination. Students who are strong in proof-based reasoning are not always equally strong in fast algorithmic execution, and the reverse is also true. Kristiyan brings both together. That combination gives him unusual flexibility and makes him especially promising for advanced study.

Just as importantly, he has the right attitude. Kristiyan is serious, self-driven, and highly ambitious, but not in a superficial way. He is drawn to difficult problems for their own sake and is willing to work through technical obstacles patiently. He also has a broader personal side that I find distinctive and, yet at the same time, entirely fitting for someone of his character: his interest in music reflects the same appreciation for structure, rhythm, discipline, and sustained practice that one also sees in his academic work.

In summary, I consider Kristiyan Garchev an outstanding candidate for advanced graduate study. He has a strong foundation in mathematics, algorithms, and programming, excellent problem-solving instincts, serious teaching experience, and

Signed: 
Mark Markov



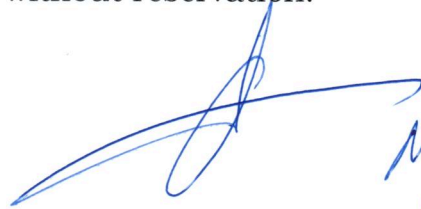
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the intellectual discipline required to thrive in a demanding academic setting. I recommend him wholeheartedly and without reservation.

Yours sincerely,

Assoc. Prof. Minko Markov

Email: minkom@fmi.uni-sofia.bg



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Markov